STRENGTH

Week 09 Strength

Week 9 of 52 | Mon 30 Nov 2026 to Sun 06 Dec 2026 | Month 2: Recovery week and checkpoint

Monday, 30 Nov Strength A - Full-body foundation (45 min)

Focus: Movement quality, tendon loading, core

Section	Details
Goblet squat	3 x 8 at 70 lb (Week 8 target 75 lb). Heels down, knees over toes, depth only as far as pain-free
Dumbbell Romanian deadlift	3 x 8 at 55 lb (Week 8 target 60 lb). Soft knees, hinge at the hip, flat back
Push-up, or dumbbell floor press if the shoulder objects	3 x 8. Pain-free only. Body in one line, elbows at 45 degrees
Single-arm dumbbell row	3 x 8 each at 70-75 lb. Pull the elbow to the hip, no torso twist. Rows are the safe direction for the shoulder
Low box jump or step-up	3 x 6. Soft, quiet landings. Skip the jump on any day the Achilles is above 2/10
Dead bug	3 x 8 each side. Low back glued to the floor
Side plank	3 x 30 s each. Hips stacked
Eccentric heel drops, straight and bent knee	3 x 12-15 each at 90 lb. Slow 3 s lowering. This is the most important exercise in the session

Notes: Warm up 5 min easy, then 10 bodyweight squats, 10 hinges, 10 arm circles. Rest 60-90 s. Fasted is fine at this length. Week 9: light. Weights down 20-30%, reps as listed.

Friday, 04 Dec Strength B - Hips, knees, core (35 min)

Focus: Glute medius, patellar tracking, trunk stability. Now on its own day, no run before it.

Section	Details
Machine glute thrust (replaces glute bridge)	3 x 8 starting at 150 lb. Your Sep 20 top was 250 lb; start light and leave 3 reps in reserve, add 10-20 lb per week
Clamshell with band	3 x 15 each. Pelvis does not roll back
Monster walk	3 x 10 steps each way. Stay low, knees out
Step-down from low step	3 x 10 each. Knee over second toe, slow. Watch the knee the next morning
Wall sit	3 x 30 s. Progress time, not depth
Bent-knee calf raise (seated, weight on thigh)	3 x 15 at 90 lb (Week 8 target 100 lb). Slow up, slow down
Bird dog	3 x 8 each side. Hips level, reach long
Pallof press (band)	3 x 8 each side. Resist the rotation
Front plank	3 x 30 s. Squeeze glutes, breathe. Count 10-second blocks out loud
Single-leg balance	3 x 30 s each. Eyes closed if easy

Notes: Warm up 5 min walk or easy spin. Light. Keep heel drops and calf raises at full volume.